

The Night of Iron Knives

Though disputes were common, they rarely turned to open violence between the Arcadians and commoners. However, a clandestine group of Arcadian sidhe invited the most prominent commoner leaders to a Beltaine masquerade to initiate peace talks in earnest, and to celebrate achievements preformed during the Interregnum. Though distrustful of invitations, the commoners felt secure in the honor of sidhe. While waiting for their hosts to arrive, the commoners gathered in the dining hall of the estate to which they were invited, only to be slaughtered by masked assassins wielding cold iron knives.

News of the Beltaine Massacre quickly spread on both sides of the conflict and, as commoners prepared for revenge, the demands of House Fiona to investigate and punish guilty parties went unheard. The time for discussions ended with blood on the walls, and only war remained.

The Accordance War

10 days after the Beltaine Massacre, the returned nobility gathered beneath the banner of High King Lord Dafyll, First Lord of War of House Gwydion, who wielded the legendary symbol of leadership, Caliburn of the Dreaming's Heart. Under his command, the Arcadian forces initiated the first act of the Accordance War, a historical event known to changelings as the Battle of the Bay in San Francisco. Dafyll's reputation as a skilled leader proved true as the sidhe conquered the city in less than a week. Once the city was secured, Dafyll ordered his troops to conquer the nation, following a northeast-bound pattern.

While mortals fought in Vietnam, so too did the Kithain go to war. Increasing amounts of disturbances during demonstrations, gang violence, and riots occupied mortal police departments, while fae fought to determine the future of their kingdoms. War crimes took place on both sides, and commoners didn't restrain themselves from using cold iron weaponry as a reminder of the Beltaine massacre. What the Arcadian sidhe lacked in modern weaponry, though, they quickly made up with access to forgotten Arts and powerful Unleashing.

Refusing to surrender in the face of their magically superior enemies, commoners continued the war, making the Arcadian sidhe pay for every freehold and inch of territory they occupied. Along the road, their bond with the Dreaming led returnees to rediscover lost trods and balefires, on which they then constructed freeholds from which to rule their courts.

The Battle of Manhattan

In December of 1973, the High King's forces surrounded New York City by taking out vital commoner holdings to the north and south of the city. The city's commoner general, a renowned and honorable troll strategist named Lyros, saw through the sidhe's tactics, and realized that the plan was to gather the commoners in Manhattan before making one final, assertive strike to end the resistance. In response, General Lyros ordered commoners to withdraw to the island while leaving enough defenses to convince the Arcadian forces that their strategy

worked, and to make them pay for every inch of territory with Glamour and blood.

Once the Battle of Manhattan commenced in earnest, the High King ventured out onto the field, hoping to face General Lyros in honorable combat. While land traded masters rapidly, the sidhe had the upper hand and slowly encircled Lyros' headquarters. In a final effort to catch the nobility off guard, the troll general ordered all his forces to disperse and engage in street battles rather than organized war. His decision to do so changed the tide of the war, and battles raged across the entire island.

Despite failed attempts to establish the exact events leading up to the High King's demise, only a few facts are certain. Dafyll, and his personal guards, encountered a superior commoner troop consisting of sluagh and redcaps. While his guard fought the attackers, giving the High King time to flee, Dafyll sought refuge in the subway tunnels beneath the city. His body was found a short time later, with a knife of cold iron in his back. Despite frantically searching for Caliburn, neither nobles nor commoners were able to find it. As the symbol of leadership vanished, the Dreaming invaded the minds of soothsayers across the nation, leaving a mysterious prophecy with them.

David Ardry, High King

In an effort to spare some of the younger Arcadians the horrors of a prolonged and bloody war, the returned houses appointed the famous Grand Bard of the Fae, True Thomas, as guardian for a small group of sidhe. Over a year passed, and the bard and his wards led a quiet but comfortable life at his home in upstate New York. Following the High King's death, Lyros had difficulties controlling the most violent changelings in his army. On New Year's Eve, 1973, Thomas learned that a motley of redcaps were making their way towards his home, intent on slaying all Arcadian sidhe there. Hoping to rescue his wards, Thomas saw only one way out of the situation and brought them into New York to hide in plain sight behind enemy lines. Despite being a sound plan due to the vast number of mortals celebrating New Year's Eve, a redcap patrol spotted them among the revelers in Times Square shortly before midnight.

Using his Arts, the Grand Bard called for his wards to hide behind him while he fended off their attackers. Unnoticed by both sides of the conflict, one of the Arcadian sidhe, a young teenaged boy named David Ardry, snuck into an alleyway. As the battle commenced moments before, David sensed an immense surge of Glamour, and when he realized it went unnoticed by everyone else, he heard a voice calling out for him. He went after the source of the Glamour, and as the final bell tolled and the new year dawned, David returned to assist his guardian, with Caliburn in hand. True Thomas turned to the assailants and exclaimed, "Behold! You do look upon your king!" Frightened by Caliburn's reappearance, and awed by the sight of the new High King, the redcaps quickly dispersed into the crowd.

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Following their encounter with destiny, True Thomas quickly brought the young sidhe, David's sister Morwen, and the other wards to the safety of Queen Mab's Court in the